

Question 1 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

Explain the concept of Human Resource Development (HRD) and state its major objectives.

Answer

Human Resource Development (HRD) is a planned, continuous organisational process that helps employees acquire capabilities, realise potential, and build a culture of collaboration. Leonard Nadler (1969) defined HRD as organised learning experiences, conducted within a specified time, designed to produce behavioural change. Prof. T.V. Rao described HRD as a process by which employees are helped in a continuous and planned way to develop role-related and general capabilities and a healthy work culture.

- 1. Capability for present and future roles:** HRD aims to help employees acquire or sharpen knowledge, skills and attitudes needed for current jobs and expected future roles.
- 2. Development of inner potential:** A major objective is to help individuals discover and use their potential for personal growth as well as organisational development.
- 3. Culture building:** HRD seeks a culture of strong superior-subordinate relations, teamwork and collaboration among units, contributing to motivation and professional pride.
- 4. Continuous planned learning:** Unlike one-off training, HRD is ongoing. Mechanisms such as appraisal, counselling, training and OD are used to keep the process alive.
- 5. Individual, dyad, group and organisation:** Development covers the person, the boss-subordinate pair, teams/committees, departments and the whole organisation.
- 6. Enabling climate:** HRD aims to create a climate that identifies, nurtures and uses human potential, because unlike other resources people have relatively unlimited capability.
- 7. Performance and growth orientation:** Objectives include higher individual effectiveness, organisational dynamism, adaptability and long-term competitiveness.
- 8. Formal and informal modes:** Classroom training, coaching, mentoring, career development, succession planning and OD interventions all serve HRD objectives.

Conclusion. Thus, HRD is not merely training; it is a philosophy and process that develops people, climate and organisation together so that both individual and organisational goals are achieved.